

3.2 Assessment information

Summary of visit or case study	Students should produce a brief summary of the case study or physics-based visit as homework. It is recommended that students word process this part of the assessment. The summary should be between 500–600 words.
Plan	Students may be given the title of the experiment that they are to plan and carry out in advance. The plan should be produced under supervised conditions in class in the students' own handwriting. Students should not take any documents into the classroom as they should have gained sufficient experience of planning practical work during normal practical lessons. Teachers should collect in the plan at the end of the session to check for health and safety issues. The plan will need to be returned to students so that they can carry out their plan. At this stage teachers could either: i) photocopy the plan, mark the original plan if it is to be internally assessed and provide students with the photocopy in the laboratory so that they can carry out their plan ii) collect in the plan, not mark it and return it to students in the laboratory under supervised conditions so that they can carry out their plan.
Practical	The practical work should be carried out under supervised conditions in a separate session from the planning session. Unmarked plans should be returned to students so that they can carry out the experiment that they have planned. Students should work individually. If necessary, teachers may allow students to analyse results under supervision in their next lesson. In this situation, teachers must collect in the written work produced by their students. Teachers should not mark the plan or practical work. In the next lesson, the documents should be returned to students under supervised conditions for analysis. Students should not have access to any other sources of information while they are completing the analysis of their results

Assessing work	The assessment criteria are shown in the next section. Each criterion scores a maximum of 1 mark. The criteria are not hierarchical. The assessment of the summary of the visit or the case study, together with the planning, the recording of measurements and the analysis is based on documents produced by the students.
For centres marking the written report	The marks for the report should be submitted to Edexcel on the mark sheet for centres provided in the Edexcel <i>Coursework Guide</i> that will be available on the Edexcel website www.edexcel.org.uk. Each piece of work should be annotated by the teacher. This can be done by writing the skill code eg A10 near to the appropriate section of the report and ticking the box A10 on the grid below.
For centres not marking the written report	The written report should be submitted to Edexcel as discussed in the Edexcel <i>Coursework Guide</i> that will be available on the Edexcel website www.edexcel.org.uk .
Guidance to students	Teachers may provide guidance to students without penalty. Guidance is feedback that a teacher might reasonably be expected to give to a student who asks questions about the work that they are carrying out. In effect, the teacher is being used as a resource. Students may require assistance whereby the teacher needs to tell the student what they have to do. Assistance in this respect carries a penalty. The teacher should record details of any assistance provided on the report.
Important	Students should submit their work for assessment once only. Internally assessed work should not be given back to students to be improved.